

Title

Secondary analysis of exercise tolerance after home pulmonary rehabilitation for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease: results from linked clinical records

Abstract

A prespecified secondary analysis examined variation in exercise tolerance after home pulmonary rehabilitation among adults with chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. Effects were explored by baseline severity, age, adherence, and recruitment setting. The pattern was directionally consistent with the primary analysis, but subgroup estimates were imprecise. The analysis was designed to reflect the decisions faced by clinicians in routine practice. This report is from a parallel-group randomized controlled trial comparing Control: wait-list care vs Intervention: strength and balance exercise + inhaled anti-inflammatory therapy.